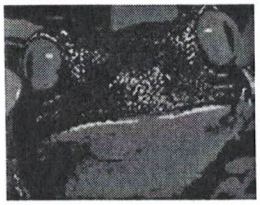
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Ghetto Blaster



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By Brian Weilert and David Ralph

Announcer: *(sang)* KB 92
You're listening to KB92, Kansas City's best late night talk with Walter Odel

Walter: Good evening listeners, you're here with Walter Odel and tonight's topic, Who is the Black Man in the 21st century?

Now, I was born in the Paseo just 5 miles from this very spot. My mother and father worked at Hallmark down at the Plaza; dad maintenance, mom 2nd shift cleaning crew. My father was a proud man, a proud black man. He was always forcing pride down my throat. I must have been dragged to the Negro Baseball hall of fame 12 times before my tenth birthday. Yes, dad was a proud Black man, but he was also a pissed off black man; angry all the time claiming "THE MAN" had cost him three promotions. He would try to insight my mother and me into his one man riot, "That's why we have to live in this tiny two-bedroom hole with faded shutters and chipping paint that's why you ain't got a new ball glove boy, and why your momma has to save ol' bacon fat in that green-bean can to cook with!" He could keep this up for hours. Dad would come home at night filled with ideas for his own greeting cards.
"How's this? Front: Sorry to hear about you not getting that promotion. Inside: But DAMN whitey didn't want you to have it!"

Or this one

"Front: you have a picture of a black man bent over the hood of a car. Inside it says, 'Call Bubba's Bail Bondsman for those times when profiling bends you over for whitey!'"

Dad liked the word whitey, whitey and THE MAN.

Problem was, I just didn't get it. I had a friend once who was white and I liked him. Sorry, I just couldn't resist. Seems every white person I ever talked to tries to weasel into the conversation at one point or another that they had a friend who was black. Like they needed to prove they weren't racist.

For those of you just tuning in and have never listened to the show I will just come right out and say it, I am a black man. But just who am I and how do I fit in, in the good old 21st century?

That is the topic of tonight's show. I will be taking callers at 1 800 459 0092 after this message from one of our sponsors.

AD

(Sound of a can opening) Gulp, gulp, gulp Ahhhhhh. I used to drink those pints of water others called beer until I found the best. McDougals Irish beer is the stoutest around; made with only the hardiest of hops and barley. McDougals is the drinkin' man's beer. In fact if you're not staggerin' after six, then you must be Irish!
McDougal's Premium Irish beer, brewed since 1842.

Walter: Well, we are back and we have our first caller, a Mr. McNalley from Overland Park. Mr. McNalley you're on the air with Walter.

McNalley: (Irish accent, obviously drunk) Ah, I've been a listenin' to the show for a about three weeks now since my wife booted me out of me own house screamin' like a banshee 'bout me being a drunken bum. Her words, not mine. Anyway, I want you to know I like what you have to say.

Walter: Thanks, for the personal history there Mr. McNalley

McNalley: Call me Jimmy.

Walter: Ok, you got it. Jimmy, what do you have to say about the state of the Blackman in the 21st century?

McNalley: Well, Mr. Odell, that's Irish isn't it? No matter, we Irish have been the blacks of Europe for Centuries and I know your plight.

Walter: Never said I had a plight, but go on.

McNalley: I know what it's like to be poked fun of as being a drunk just because of where God graced me to be born.

Walter: Jimmy, are we drunk tonight?

McNalley: I had a few but why does it matter? Me wife had done left me and I have no reason to go on livinə.

Walter: Well, now Jimmy that sounds just awful but do you have anything to say on tonight's topic?

McNalley: Are you daf man! I'm tryin' to tell you but you just won't listen. I told you my wife won't let me back in and I have no hope! Do you hear me Walter?

Walter: I do man. I can tell you're hurting. Perhaps you can call back tomorrow morning at 7:00am when Dr. Flagen has her call-in show? Thanks (Click)
That was Mr. McNalley. I think we can take a couple of things from what just went on even though Jimmy never really seemed to be on topic. One is that others are still struggling to find where they too fit in. The black man is not alone. And two, stereo-types can be reinforced by just a few. And if you are one of those few then don't complain when people call you what you are.

We'll be right back after this brief message.

AD

Is your car bling-bling
But your system won't sing-sing?
Roll on down to Bass-R-Us
And we'll hook you up with the
Phattest sound in K.C.
We have it all, woofers, subwoofers, tweeters,
and the biggest bass cannons in all the land.
If your ride sound like... (weak sound)
But you want it to sound like this,(big booming bass sound)
Then roll on down to Bass-R-Us on 5th, just two blocks of S. I 35

Walter: We are back, our next caller is D Pity from Independence. You're on the air with Walter.

D Pity: Sup Odel?
I know how you feelin'
Life ain't appealin'
Hit hard
Gone are the days of stealin' cars
Always hit-n-miss
Niggas got a get his
Be proud
spreadin' out like an atomic cloud
Out loud
Cutting my way like a field plowed

Walter: Whoa, D Pity, powerful words but some of our listeners may need a translation. What are you trying to say about the Blackman in the 21st century?

D Pity: You know whats I'm talkin' bout dog.

Walter: D Pity, I think my listeners need a bit more.

D Pity: You gots to be foolin,
(interrupting in the back ground the sound of an angry mother yelling)
Marvin! Marvin! You get off that phone right now! And you better not be calling that..that jiggaboo station again!

(whining) Mom! Um, I have to go. Sorry Mr. Odel. Love your show you are really cool an all.
(click)

Walter: Hmmm, something tells me that was no brother.
I think what we can learn from D Pity Marvin, is that just because you think you may have it bad, there are others out there who might envy what you've got. So, take the time to look at the good in your life, focus on what you have, not on what you don't. We'll be right back after this commercial.

AD

Woman 1: Marge, I need in-line skates to keep up with you.

Woman 2: Well you wanted the active life of a heavy machine operator. Here is something you should try.

Woman 1: Trouble-free tampons? Are they new?

Woman 2: Yes, they're beltless and have a plastic applicator

Woman 1: Thanks, I best get back to that back-hoe

(Announcer) Trouble-free tampons, for the woman on the go.

Walter: We're back. I have Tammy from Joplin on the line. Tammy what have you to say about tonight's topic?

Tammy: I think you should get over yourself Odel.. Blackman, poor, poor Blackman. You don't know how good you have it. Try being a woman. Black or white or whatever, men, ALL men, are in the drivers seat.

Walter: Problem with men, Tammy?

Tammy: No problem, just don't see why any man would complain.

Walter: I think there is a deeper issue eating at you.

Tammy: Look, I….you wouldn't understand.

Walter: Let me take a stab, abusive father?

Tammy: No

Walter: Husband? Boyfriend?

Tammy: NO!

Walter: Lesbian?

Tammy: (silence)

Walter: I said, lesbian? (pause) I guess I can assume by your silence that I am correct. Can I ask, why all the anger?

Tammy: Look, I can't believe I am even talking to you about this. It has nothing to do with your topic.

Walter: You're right, that's usually my line. But, my interest is peeked.

Tammy: You really want to know?! *(getting angry)* I'll tell you why. Because of who I am and the way I feel, my parents have disowned me. They say I should change and that God frowns on my lifestyle. That I'm not welcome in their home anymore. And I can't stand being torn between being who I really, in my heart, think I am, being hated by God and alienated by my own flesh and blood. *(near tears)* I still love my mom and dad, and…and… I still love God. Why can't they just love me back?

Walter: Powerful words Tammy. I'm not sure I have the answers for you. I do know two things. One, God hates no one. And two, that acceptance is something we all want at some level. We think that we should be taken into the fold based solely on who we are, but that's a fantasy. The fact is that the world is often cruel and we have to change, alter bits and pieces of ourselves to fit in. The question is just a matter of how important belonging is in comparison to maintaining our self identity. You see Tammy, your problem is right in line with tonight's topic. The very heart of who the Black Man is, is tied to the very quandary you face. Is a black man who adapts to the world around him in order to find success, a sell out? An Uncle Tom? Or is it simply an evolution of mankind? Sadly there is no clear answer.

Tammy: Thank you Walter, good night. *(click)*

Walter: Good night Tammy. Our line are open, please give us a call at 1 800 459 0092 and we'll listen to what you have to say, right after this word from one of our sponsors.

AD

This Saturday only
JC Penny's is having the biggest whites only sale.
Take 20% off all cotton towels
30% off all cotton wash cloths
And an amazing 90% off all white cotton sheets
Don't miss JC Penny's whites only sale
9:00 a.m. to 9:00 pm
This Saturday

Walter: Welcome back. I have a very interesting man on the line. I have a Mr. Larson. He won't give me his first name. In fact, he insist I should just call him sir. So, I we'll make up a first name for him. We'll just call him Leslie. Leslie, you're on the air with Walter.

Leslie: You spear chucking, jungle bunny, you better call me SIR!!!

Walter: Leslie, what have you to say on tonight's topic of the state of the Blackman in the 21st century?

Leslie: You call me Leslie one more time you black piece of garbage and I will come down to that station and knock you all the way back to Africa! I called to say that the blacks are taking over everything. It's gotten to a point where a white man can't go anywhere without seeing 'em. Work, stores, in cars on the roads I drive, on tv, movies. Hell, even you on the radio. What state do I think the (sarcastic) Blackman is in? I think the (sarcastic) Blackman is in every damn state in this once great country. I think the (sarcastic) Blackman needs to drag his lazy, stealing, drug using monkey-ass back to where he came from. That's what I think!!!!

Walter: Leslieeee, you seem to have some built-up anger toward the Blackman. Leslieeeee, you also seem to be everything that is wrong with our great country. I find you to be so ignorant that I am amused by you, Leslieeeee.
Leslieeee are you still there? *(silence)* Leslieeeee? *(silence)*

It appears as though Leslie has hung up. I think what Leslie was trying to say is that no matter what century, there will be those who live in the past, destroying the future for all of us who are ready to move on.

I will be back to wrap things up after this final message.

AD

September 11th was a day that will be remembered forever. The American Red Cross would like thank all of those who helped during that tragic time. However, the Red Cross would also like to remind you that their work is never done. Donating blood is vital for the lives of so many Americans in need. Please, make the time, give the gift of life; donate blood.

Walter: We're back. I would like cap off tonight with these thoughts on what I have learned about the topic of, "What is the state of "Blackman" in the 21st century?" I learned, I think I have been asking the wrong question. To be honest I am not ever sure what the question ought to be but I do think we can turn to our friends at the Red Cross for the answer; it's blood. It pumps through the veins of every one of us, oblivious to whom we are. It doesn't care if you are an Irishman drunk on McDougal's, or a feminist backhoe operator during that time of the month, or an acne faced teenager driving around the suburbs in a low-riding, bass-thumping Geo- Metro, or the grand dragon of the KKK in his newly purchased JC Penny's white sheets or my own father still at the same job and still angry. We all share one thing in common. Blood. It doesn't accuse abuse, discriminate or hate. It's just blood and it's in me and every one of you listening. It binds us all together in spite of our many, many flaws. *(pause)* That about does it for tonight's show. I would like to thank all of you for listening. Please tune in the same time tomorrow as we will be discussing, **Whether the media has gone too far in what it allows on the air.** This is Walter Odel, signing off, God bless and peace out.

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